superstitious, the rational and the irrational, modern and traditional, historical and mythological—essentially, European and non-European. Even where the coloniser (‘the Occident’) begrudgingly admitted that there was indeed culture and civilisation outside of Europe, he resorted to stereotyping and exotification by calling it ‘the Orient’.

This racial classification of the entirety of humanity to subserve colonial interests forms the foundation of the Eurocentric world order. In fact, Quijano highlighted the relationship between European colonialism and globalisation that resulted in Western hegemony over all of human experience. Critically, this included control over all forms of subjectivity, culture and production of knowledge. Quijano did not mince words in calling the phenomenon of globalisation the ‘culmination of a process that began with the constitution of America and colonial/modern Eurocentered capitalism as a new global power’. Race and, therefore, coloniality remain as relevant today as they were in the colonial era, notwithstanding globalisation’s professed love for the concept of a ‘global village’. Simply put, globalisation, contrary to popular perception, is not a friend of diversity, nor is it a melting pot of cultures. On the contrary, it denotes the gradual and unconscious eradication of heterogeneity, more particularly, the diversity of indigeneity, and is proof of existence of common denominators of culture and civilisation for the entire world, which are distinctly Western-normative in character.

Quijano also argued that any attempts to obfuscate history by taking the position that modernity was not European but was merely a reference to newness of ideas, would be tantamount to turning a blind eye to the colonialism of the last five centuries, which had lent specific meanings to modernity and rationality that are distinctly European in nature. In other words, the totalising effect of European colonisation since the Age of Discovery has given the word ‘modernity’ a distinct historical connotation that is impossible to ignore given the continuing presence of coloniality.[12] Critically, Quijano acknowledged that while colonialism may have existed in different parts of the world in different forms prior to European colonisation, none of them compared to European colonialism’s vision of global domination. This is because European coloniality required the entire world to share a common perspective on the entirety of human history and experience.